

The benefits of doing nothing - 6 Minute English

BBC Learning English

아무것도 하지 않는 것의 놀라운 효과 — BBC 6분 영어

Beginner

6:19

DURATION

152

WPM

42

SEGMENTS

20

VOCABULARY

10

GRAMMAR



[10-Step Study →](#)

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01 Video Structure Overview

This 6-minute video by BBC Learning English is structured into 5 key sections.

1 intro

0:08 ~ 1:12

베스와 닐이 주제를 소개해요. 닐은 바쁜 하루에 지쳐 있는 반면 베스는 아무것도 하지 않고 있었어요. 베스는 대부분의 동물이 대부분의 시간을 비활동 상태로 보낸다는 놀라운 사실을 소개하며, 왜 동물들이 아무것도 하지 않도록 진화했는지, 게으름이 인간에게도 도움이 될 수 있는지라는 핵심 질문을 던져요.

Contrast between Neil's busy day and Beth doing nothing

Most animals spend most of their time doing nothing

Central question: can laziness benefit humans?

2 body

1:12 ~ 2:24

베스가 지구에서 가장 느린 동물에 대한 퀴즈를 내요. 부지런한 것으로 알려진 개미조차 절반의 시간을 아무것도 하지 않고 보낸다는 사실이 밝혀져요. 댄 샤르보노 교수의 개미 군체 연구가 소개돼요.

Quiz: what is the slowest moving animal on earth?

Even busy ants spend half their time motionless

Introduction of Professor Dan Charbonneau's ant research

3 body

2:24 ~ 3:22

전문가 토론에서 개미가 근면함의 상징으로 여겨지지만 실제로 군체의 약 절반이 항상 비활동 상태라는 것이 밝혀져요. 비활동 개미가 비상시를 위한 예비 인력일 수 있다는 가능한 설명이 탐구되고, 인간 행동과의 유사점이 제시돼요.

Ants symbolize industriousness but half are inactive

Inactive ants may serve as reserves for emergencies

Parallel drawn to human reluctance to work unnecessarily

4 body

3:23 ~ 4:50

심리학자 샌디 만 박사는 생산적인 것이 과대평가되어 있으며 지루함에 중요한 장점이 있다고 주장해요. 지루함이 호기심과 발명을 촉진한다며 '지루함이 발명의 어머니'라는 생각을 제시해요. 하지만 현대 기술의 끊임없는 자극이 머리를 쉬게 하는 것을 더 어렵게 만들어요. 역설: 지루함을 극복하려면 오히려 더 많은 지루함을 허용해야 해요.

Being productive is overrated according to Dr Sandy Mann

Boredom fuels curiosity and invention

Modern technology's constant stimulation prevents switching off

Paradox: allow more boredom to overcome boredom

5 conclusion

4:50 ~ 6:13

베스가 퀴즈 정답(세 발가락 나무늘보)을 공개하고 진행자들이 핵심 어휘를 복습해요: kicking back, industrious, colony, productive, necessity is the mother of invention, switch off. 프로그램은 아무것도 하지 말라는 가벼운 격려로 마무리돼요.

Quiz answer: three-toed sloth (30cm per minute, algae grows on coat)

Vocabulary recap of six key terms

Light-hearted closing: encouragement to do nothing

02 Essential Vocabulary

Core words from the video that are high-value for learners.

exhausted /ɪgˈzɔːstɪd/ adjective

extremely tired; completely drained of energy

기진맥진한, 완전히 지친

Latin 'exaurire' meaning 'to drain out'

ex-

haust (draw, drain)

-ed

"I'm exhausted, Beth. What have you been doing today?"

Related: exhaust, exhaustion, exhausting

kicking back /ˈkɪkɪŋ bæk/ phrasal verb

to stop doing things and relax completely

느긋하게 쉬다, 편하게 놀다

American English slang from the imagery of leaning back in a chair with feet up

kick (push with foot)

back (behind)

"Just sitting around, doing nothing, relaxing and kicking back."

Related: relax, unwind, chill out

documentary /ˌdɒkjʊˈmentəri/ noun

a film or TV programme giving facts about a real subject

다큐멘터리, 기록 영화

Latin 'documentum' meaning 'lesson, proof'

document (evidence, record)

-ary

"If you've seen nature documentaries about worker bees flying from flower to flower."

Related: document, documentation, documented

evolved /ɪˈvɒlvd/ verb

developed gradually over a long period of time through natural processes

진화한, 점진적으로 발달한

Latin 'evolvere' meaning 'to unroll, to unfold'

e- (out)

volv (roll, turn)

-ed

"Why have some animals evolved to do nothing?"

Related: evolution, evolve, revolve

shelter /ˈʃɛltər/ noun

a place giving protection from weather or danger

은신처, 피난처, 보호소

Old English 'scieldtruma' meaning 'shield troop, protective formation'

shelt (shield, protect)

-er

"In the natural world, where finding food and shelter is hard work."

Related: sheltered, sheltering, shield

reputation /ˌrɛpjuˈteɪʃən/ noun

the beliefs or opinions generally held about someone or something

평판, 명성

Latin 'reputatio' from 'reputare' meaning 'to think over'

re-

put (think, reckon)

-ation

"Some animals have a reputation for lounging about."

Related: repute, reputable, disreputable

sloth /slɒθ/ noun

a slow-moving tropical mammal; also means laziness or reluctance to work

나무늘보; 나태함, 게으름

Old English 'slæwþ' from 'slow' meaning 'slow, inactive'

slow (not fast)

-th

"Well, I think it's the three-toed sloth."

Related: slothful, slow, lazy

motionless /ˈməʊʃənləs/ adjective

not moving; completely still

움직이지 않는, 정지한

Latin 'motio' (movement) + English '-less' (without)

motion (movement)

-less (without)

"Half of them just sitting there motionless."

Related: motion, motionlessness, still

colony /ˈkɒləni/ noun

a group of certain animals living together, such as ants or seabirds

군체, (동물의) 집단, 군락

Latin 'colonia' from 'colonus' meaning 'farmer, settler'

colon (settle, cultivate)

-y

"Dan's research has focused on ant colonies."

Related: colonial, colonize, colonist

industrious /ɪnˈdʌstriəs/ adjective

diligent and hard-working

부지런한, 근면한

Latin 'industria' meaning 'diligence, activity'

industr (diligence)

-ious

"I think ants are sort of a symbol of, like, industriousness."

Related: industry, industrial, industrialize

inactive /ɪnˈæktɪv/ adjective

not doing anything; not active or working

비활동적인, 활동하지 않는

Latin 'in-' (not) + 'activus' (active)

in- (not)

act (do, perform)

-ive

"Roughly about half the colony is inactive at any given time."

Related: active, inactivity, activate

reserve /rɪˈzɜːv/ noun/adjective

kept back for future use; a supply stored for emergencies

예비의, 비축분, 대비용

Latin 'reservare' meaning 'to keep back, save'

re- (back)

serv (keep, save)

-e

"One possible answer is that they're reserve ants, ready to step in if disease or disaster strike."

Related: reservation, reserved, preserve

productive /prəˈdʌktɪv/ adjective

able to produce a lot for the amount of resources used

생산적인, 효율적인

Latin 'productivus' from 'producere' meaning 'to bring forth'

pro- (forward)

duct (lead, bring)

-ive

"She thinks being productive is overrated."

Related: produce, production, productivity

overrated /ˌəʊvəˈreɪtɪd/ adjective

rated or valued more highly than deserved

과대평가된

English 'over-' (excessively) + 'rate' (evaluate) + '-ed'

over- (too much)

rate (evaluate)

-ed

"She thinks being productive is overrated."

Related: underrated, rate, rating

stimulation /ˌstɪmjʊˈleɪʃən/ noun

the action of encouraging interest or activity in something

자극, 흥분, 활성화

Latin 'stimulare' meaning 'to goad, urge'

stimul (goad, prick)

-ation

"But in this world of constant stimulation, switching off is harder than it's ever been."

Related: stimulate, stimulus, stimulating

paradox /ˈpærədɒks/ noun

a statement or situation that seems contradictory but may be true

역설, 모순

Greek 'paradoxon' from 'para-' (contrary to) + 'doxa' (opinion)

para- (contrary to)

dox (opinion, belief)

"So it's a kind of paradox to get rid of this unpleasant state of boredom is actually to allow more boredom into your life."

Related: paradoxical, orthodox, unorthodox

curiosity /ˌkjʊərəiˈɒsɪti/

noun

a strong desire to know or learn something

호기심

Latin 'curiositas' from 'curiosus' meaning 'careful, inquisitive'

cur (care)

-iosity

"Doctor Mann doubts humans would have invented things without the curiosity that comes from being bored."

Related: curious, curiously, cure

03 Additional Vocabulary

Supplementary words that appear in the video and are useful for expanding your vocabulary.

lounging /'laʊndʒɪŋ/

verb

relaxing or resting in a lazy, comfortable way

빈둥거리다, 느긋하게 쉬다

Possibly from French 'longis' meaning 'a slow, lazy person'

lounge (recline lazily)

-ing

"Some animals have a reputation for lounging about."

Related: lounge, lounger, laze

idealised /aɪ'diəlaɪzd/

adjective

regarded or represented as perfect or better than reality

이상화된, 실제보다 좋게 표현된

Greek 'idea' meaning 'form, notion' + suffix '-ize' + '-ed'

ideal (perfect standard)

-ised

"There's some idealised version of what humans might be."

Related: ideal, idealism, idealize

algae /'ældʒiː/

noun

simple plants that grow in or near water, with no true stems, roots, or leaves

조류(藻類), 말(물속 식물)

Latin 'alga' meaning 'seaweed'

alga (seaweed)

-e (plural)

"Three-toed sloths move so slowly that algae grows on their coats."

Related: algal, algae bloom, seaweed

04 Grammar Patterns

Key grammar structures used in the video. Each pattern includes real examples.

Present perfect continuous: have/has been + verb-ing

Used to describe an action that started in the past and continues to the present, or has just stopped. Emphasizes the duration or ongoing nature of the activity.

현재완료 진행형(have/has been + 동사-ing)은 과거에 시작되어 현재까지 계속되거나 방금 멈춘 행동을 나타내요. 행동의 지속성이나 진행 중인 성격을 강조해요.

What have you been doing today?

as + adjective + as + noun (simile)

A comparison structure used to say two things are equal in some quality. Often used in idiomatic expressions like 'as busy as a bee.'

'as + 형용사 + as + 명사' 구조는 두 가지가 어떤 특성에서 동등하다고 비교할 때 사용해요. 'as busy as a bee'(벌처럼 바쁜)처럼 관용적 표현에 자주 쓰여요.

I'm actually as busy as a bee.

Conditional: If + present perfect, present simple

This mixed conditional links a past experience (present perfect) to a present result or belief. It connects something that has already happened to a current state of thinking.

'If + 현재완료, 현재시제' 혼합 조건문은 과거 경험(현재완료)을 현재의 결과나 믿음(현재시제)에 연결해요. 이미 일어난 일이 현재 생각에 어떻게 영향을 주는지 보여줘요.

If you've seen nature documentaries about worker bees, you probably think animals are always on the move.

Where + clause (relative clause of place)

A relative clause introduced by 'where' to add information about a place or situation. It provides additional context without starting a new sentence.

'where'로 시작하는 관계절은 장소나 상황에 대한 추가 정보를 제공해요. 새로운 문장을 시작하지 않고 맥락을 더해줘요.

In the natural world, where finding food and shelter is hard work, why have some animals evolved to do nothing?

Imperative: Look / verb + adverb for instructions

The imperative form is used to give direct instructions or commands to the listener. Adding an adverb modifies how the action should be done.

명령형은 듣는 사람에게 직접적인 지시나 명령을 할 때 사용해요. 부사를 추가하면 행동을 어떻게 해야 하는지 구체화해요.

Look carefully into an ant's nest and you'll see around half...

Conditional: Would + verb (hypothetical)

Used to talk about imaginary or hypothetical situations. 'Would' indicates something that is not real but is being considered as a possibility.

'would + 동사원형'은 가상의 상황이나 비현실적인 상황을 이야기할 때 사용해요. 실체가 아니지만 가능성으로 고려하는 것을 나타내요.

Would you get out of bed on Monday morning if you didn't have to?

Would humans have invented bread or beer or fire if we hadn't been bored?

Subjunctive / third conditional: If + past perfect, would have + past participle

The third conditional expresses an unreal condition in the past and its hypothetical result. It talks about what would have happened if a past situation had been different.

3차 조건문(If + 과거완료, would have + 과거분사)은 과거의 비현실적 조건과 그 가상 결과를 표현해요. 과거 상황이 달랐다면 무엇이 일어났을지를 말해요.

Would humans have invented bread or beer or fire if we hadn't been bored?

Comparative + than + present perfect: harder than it's ever been

A comparative structure combined with present perfect to express that something has reached an extreme level compared to all past experience.

비교급 + than + 현재완료 구조는 모든 과거 경험과 비교하여 어떤 것이 극단적인 수준에 도달했음을 표현해요. '그 어느 때보다 더 ~한'이라는 의미예요.

Switching off is harder than it's ever been.

That's why + clause (cause-result)

Used to explain the reason or cause for something that follows. It connects a previously stated fact to its consequence.

'That's why + 절'은 이전에 언급한 사실과 그 결과를 연결하는 인과관계 표현이에요. '그래서 ~인 거예요'라고 해석해요.

That's why we're constantly swiping and scrolling and looking for the next big thing.

so + adjective + that + clause (result clause)

A structure used to show that something has such an extreme quality that it leads to a particular result. Emphasizes degree and consequence.

'so + 형용사 + that + 절' 구조는 어떤 것의 정도가 극단적이어서 특정 결과를 초래함을 보여줘요. '너무 ~해서 ...하다'로 해석해요.

Three-toed sloths move so slowly that algae grows on their coats.

05 Connected Speech & Pronunciation

Natural pronunciation patterns found in the talk. Practice these to sound more natural!

Reduction (축약)

I've spent a → **아이브 스펀터**

/aɪv spentə/

'I have'가 'I've'로 축약되어 한 음절이 되고, 관사 'a'가 /ə/로 약화되어 'spent'와 자연스럽게 이어져요.

'아이 해브 스펀트 어'라고 또박또박 발음하지 말고, '아이브 스펀터'처럼 자연스럽게 연결해서 발음해 보세요.

sort of a → **소러버**

/sɔː rtəvə/

'of'와 'a' 모두 /ə/로 약화되어 세 단어가 하나로 합쳐져요. 자연스러운 발화에서 '소러버'처럼 들려요.

'소트 오브 어'라고 또박또박 발음하지 말고, '소러버'처럼 'of'와 'a'를 가볍게 /ə/로만 발음해 보세요.

to allow more → **터얼라우 모어**

/tə ə'laʊ moː/

'to'가 비강세 위치에서 /tə/로 약화되고, 'allow'의 모음과 자연스럽게 연결돼요. 기능어는 자연스러운 발화에서 보통 약하게 발음돼요.

'투 얼라우'라고 강하게 발음하지 말고, 'to'를 /tə/로 약하게 하여 '터얼라우'처럼 이어 보세요.

Linking (연음)

most of → **모스터브**

/məʊstəv/

'most'의 마지막 /t/가 약화된 'of'의 모음 /ə/와 연결되어 두 단어가 하나처럼 흘러가요.

'모스트 오브'라고 끊어 발음하지 말고, '모스터브'처럼 /t/와 /ə/를 부드럽게 연결해 보세요.

step in if → **스테피니프**

/step ɪn ɪf/

'step'의 /p/가 'in'의 /ɪ/와 연결되고, 'in'의 /n/이 'if'의 /ɪ/와 이어져요. 자음-모음 연결이 세 단어를 매끄럽게 연쇄시켜요.

'스텝 인 이프'라고 끊어 발음하지 말고, '스테피니프'처럼 세 단어를 끊김 없이 이어서 발음해 보세요.

Elision (탈락)

work up the → **워컵더**

/wɜː kʌp ðə/

'work'의 /k/가 'up'의 /ʌ/와 합쳐지고, 'up'의 /p/가 약화된 'the' /ðə/와 연결돼요. 자음군이 단순화돼요.

'워크 업 더'라고 세 단어를 따로 발음하지 말고, '워컵더'처럼 빠르게 이어서 발음해 보세요.

constant stimulation → **콘스턴 스티물레이션**

/ˈkɒnstən stɪmjʊˈleɪʃən/

'constant'의 마지막 /t/가 'stimulation'의 /s/ 앞에서 탈락하는 경우가 많아요. 두 자음군이 만나면 파열음 하나가 보통 생략돼요.

'콘스탄트 스티물레이션'이라고 /t/를 분명히 발음하지 말고, '콘스턴 스티물레이션'처럼 /t/를 생략해 보세요.

Assimilation (동화)

ant's nest and → **앤티 네스턴드**

/ænts nɛstənd/

'nest'의 /t/가 뒤따르는 'and'의 /ə/와 동화되고, 'and' 자체도 /ənd/ 또는 /ən/으로 축약돼요. 전체 구가 하나로 섞여 들려요.

'네스트 앤드'라고 강하게 발음하지 말고, 'nest'의 /t/를 약하게 하면서 'and'를 /ən/으로 빠르게 이어 보세요.

06 Signal Expressions

Key phrases used to structure the content. Learning these helps you follow presentations.

EMPHASIS

"Phew, I've spent a day in meetings"

바쁜 일상을 생생하게 보여주며 주제(아무것도 하지 않기)와의 대비를 만들어요

TRANSITION

"It may not look it, Neil, but"

겉보기와 실제의 차이를 소개하며 동물 세계의 놀라운 사실로 전환해요

EMPHASIS

"But the surprising truth is"

청중의 기대를 뒤집는 핵심 사실을 강조하며 소개해요

TRANSITION

"That's what we'll be discussing in this programme"

프로그램의 방향을 안내하며 본격적인 논의로 전환해요

TRANSITION

"But first, let me work up the energy to ask you a question"

유머러스하게 퀴즈 코너를 소개하며 주제와 연결해요

TRANSITION

"Here's Professor Dan Charbonneau"

외부 전문가의 목소리를 도입하며 과학적 근거로 전환해요

TRANSITION

"But then when you look at it"

이상과 현실의 차이를 드러내며 놀라운 연구 결과로 전환해요

TRANSITION

"Not according to psychologist Dr Sandy Mann"

새로운 전문가 관점을 소개하며 지루함의 장점이라는 새 소주제로 전환해요

TRANSITION

"But in this world of constant stimulation"

이론에서 현대 사회의 현실적 문제로 전환해요

SUMMARY

"So it's a kind of paradox"

앞선 논의를 역설적 결론으로 요약하며 핵심 메시지를 전달해요

TRANSITION

"I think now is a good time to reveal the answer"

본론에서 마무리 단계로 자연스럽게 전환해요

SUMMARY

"OK, let's recap the vocabulary"

프로그램의 학습 목표를 정리하며 어휘 복습 코너로 전환해요

Keep Learning!

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[youtube.com/watch?v=Y681hXWwhQY](https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Y681hXWwhQY)